Key Prints & Graphics: Intimates A/W 26/27

Ethereal frosted florals connect to the winter season, while unearthed textures offer newness to animal prints. #NewRetro sporty prints and #NuHistoric patterns speak to the demand for nostalgic designs

Fanny Chow
05.28.25 - 5 minutes

Need to know

Decorative and bold prints have made a comeback as consumers pursue self-expression following the dominance of #LowKeyLuxury. Designs that evoke joy and provide a sense of familiarity will prevail.

Opportunity

Prints continue to increase on the catwalk, with the best-selling prints for intimates also demonstrating growth, including florals (+2.8ppt), animal prints/skins (+2.5ppt) and small-scale florals (+0.6ppt). Leverage the familiarity of these core prints to introduce emerging trends while keeping commercial appeal, such as frosted florals and earthy skins.

Lean into the growing demand for #PyjamaDressing and the dayjama (+106% views on TikTok) to market versatile stripes and checks. Utilise #Valentines Day to introduce #OrnateMaximalism prints.

STEPIC forecasts: Kintentional, Geo-Logic, Empowered Play, Glimmers

Design strategies

- Concentrate on trends that function for various occasions to improve cost-per-wear, such as New Mod for #ActiveIntimates and Playful Simplicity for dayjamas
- Invest in #BoldMinimal socks for winter holiday gifting and Richly Opulent lingerie for the #Valentines drop
- Reduce high tariff costs by utilising onshore digital printing and using the same print fabric for accessories, which boosts speed to market and minimises overproduction

TIP: Test

Richly Opulent

Decorative designs celebrate self-expression and historical heritage following seasons of #LowKeyLuxury, suited for elegant and glamorous styles.

Design strategies

- Choose #Paisley and small-scale decorative florals for familiarity and commerciality
- Invest in sexy tulle lingerie sets and velvet robes, ideal for #Valentines Day gifting
- Apply to fashion #Bodysuit and kimono robe that can also be worn as #Layering
- Use the same printed fabric for small accessories like scrunchies and pouches to minimise waste; square scarves will appeal to the #Modest market
- Drop in January

RVNG

Coco de Mer

Coco de Mer

Harlow and Fox

@ladoublej

@etro

Hansen & Gretel

Proof points: Richly Opulent

TikTok Trading April 2025: #Maximalism: from H&M x The White Lotus to the 'boom boom' trend, all reflect **a shift from #LowKeyLuxury to maximalism for self-expression**

#OrnateMaximalism upticks on WGSN's Fashion Feed

▲ 22%

A/W 25/26 vs A/W 24/25

WGSN.com

Opulent design is trending on the WGSN Fashion Feed, influenced by **#InteriorInspired prints and #NuBoheme florals** showcased at catwalks and trade shows

Celebrating 60 years of Sino-French ties, tbh (Shanghai) and Antoinette Poisson (Paris) **reimagine 18th-century domino paper patterns with sycamore tree motifs from both cities**

original artwork

Original artwork is editable and copyright-free.

TIP: Test

New Mod

#NewRetro loungewear and sporty underwear answer the passion for the '60s era, bringing back nostalgic patterns.

Design strategies

- Focus on revamped classic patterns to add long-term appeal, such as #PreppyStripes, #PolkaDot and colour-blocked #Checkerboard
- Take cues from '60s graphical #Geometrics to introduce floral motifs and #Monogram
- Use #Clubhouse style #Branding and logos for pocket placement
- Thanks to its youthful and sporty look, apply to #ActiveIntimates and sports bras, as well as #Tween bras, lounge sets and polo sets
- Drop in October

@frace_ba

@playwithpattero

@tabio.jp

@adrianadegreas

@lennyniemeyer

@miumiu

OpéraSPORT

Proof points: New Mod

#PreppyStripes surge on WGSN's Fashion Feed

▲ 191%

2024 vs 2023

WGSN.com

Influenced by the #SportCore and #Clubhouse trend, **sporty stripes will offer wide commercial appeal for #ActiveIntimates and loungewear**

#PolkaDot takes a large share of the catwalk prints mix

▲ +1.7ppt

A/W 25/26 vs A/W 24/25

WGSN.com

Dots/spots experienced the third-largest YoY share increase after florals and animal print, proving their broad appeal

#60s looks uptrend on WGSN's Fashion Feed

▲ +21ppt

A/W 25/26 vs A/W 24/25

WGSN.com

The fascination with nostalgia signals **a throwback approach to renew '60s iconic prints** like #Geometrics and #PolkaDot

'original artwork

Original artwork is editable and copyright-free

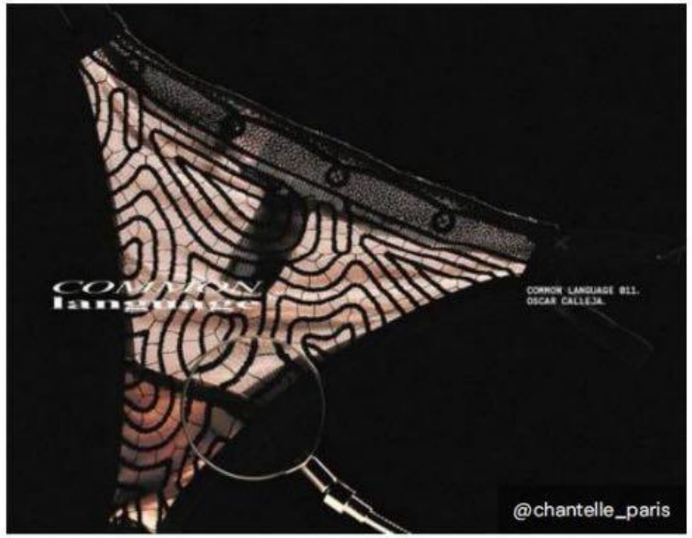
TIP: Invest

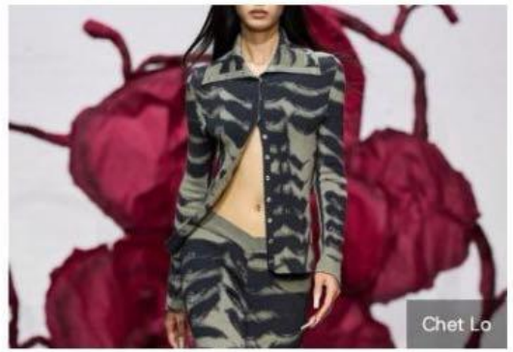
Unearthed

Update commercial-winning #AnimalPrint with an earthy approach, fulfilling consumers' desire to connect with nature.

Design strategies

- Invest in small-scale, cracked, dried textures that also nod to animal skins, emphasising the raw beauty of #NaturesTexture
- Adopt natural dyes such as Archroma's EarthColors and Mycopigment dyes and low-impact techniques like block printing
- Use #Neutrals and #SepiaTones for long-term and transseasonal appeal
- Drop in September





Proof points: Unearthed

Speckled skins thrived at A/W 25/26 catwalks, with pared-back iterations of #FiredEarth and #TrueLeopard coming to the fore

Animal prints and texture grow on catwalks

A/W 25/26 vs A/W 24/25

▲ +2.5ppt

Animal Prints/Skins

▲ +1.4ppt

Texture

WGSN.com

Both animal skins and textures exhibit a rise in the catwalk print mix, **presenting an opportunity to combine the two, aligning with the Unearthed forecast**

Earthbound skins are highlighted as a trend to invest in our S/S 26 Buyers' Briefing, with a **transseasonal appeal expected to trickle down to A/W**

'original artwork

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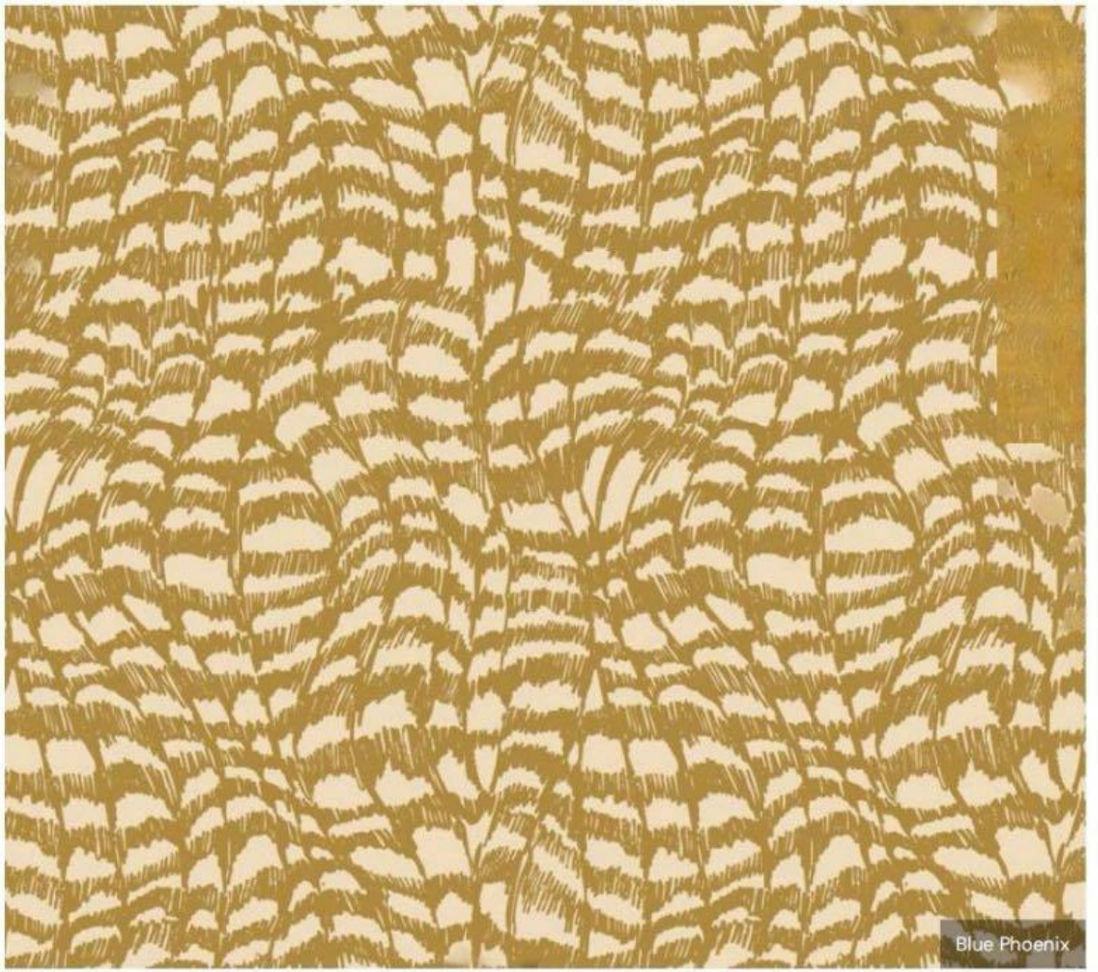


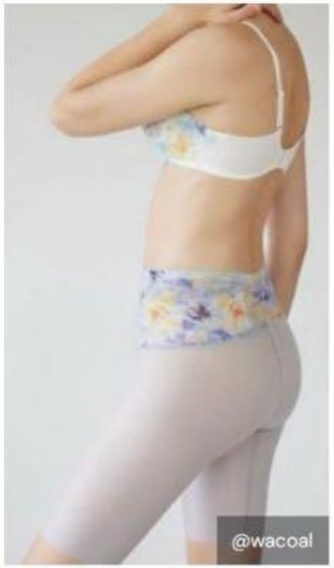
TIP: Invest

Frosted Surfaces

Hazy florals and textures create an intriguing play of opacity, resonating with an appreciation for fragile beauty.

Design strategies

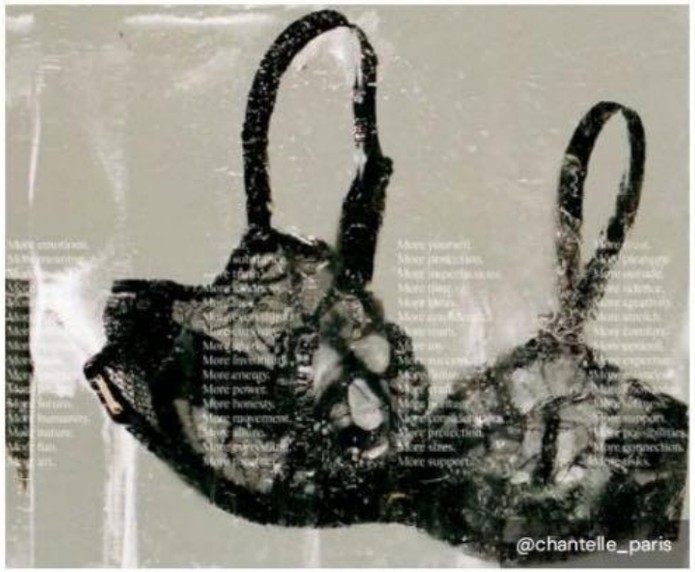
- Invest in #SoftFocus effects, #Watercolour florals and cracked ice textures to create an ethereal and serene look, suitable for wellness intimates and sleepwear
- Use water-based digital printing on FSC-certified lyocell, as well as bio-based and biodegradable nylon and polyester
- Apply to embroidery lingerie, jacquard laces and layered #Sheer sets for veiled effects
- Explore botanical printing or ice dyes to create unique pieces finished by hand, suitable for #SlipDress and #Camisole
- Drop in November


@wacoal

@amerivintage

@nette_rose

Altuzarra


@chantelle_paris

Desmond & Dempsey

@fantasie_lingerie

Proof points: Frosted Surfaces

STEPIC Strategies 2027: Environment – Climate-Changed: Organic Thinking: awareness of humans as part of the planet's ecosystem inspires **natural, weather-driven surfaces and patterns that connect us to the seasons and outdoors**

#SoftFocus upticks on WGSN's Fashion Feed

▲ 25%

2024 vs 2023

Soft and blurry effects continue to gain traction for their **sense of serenity and comfort**, offering a commercial approach to introduce florals for intimates

The exhibition Sleeping Beauties: Reawakening Fashion at the Met in New York uses technologies, including AI, to breathe new life into fragile garments and **reflects a desire to preserve the beauty of real or handmade blooms**

original artwork

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TIP: Protect

Playful Simplicity

Inject the power of play into core prints for youthful sleepwear and loungewear, appealing to youth and Kidult consumers.

Design strategies

- Focus on a naive and bold graphic style to present florals, stripes and checks
- Feature sweet and girly #KeyIcons like #Hearts, lips and cherries, suitable for camisoles, jersey tops and pyjama pocket placement
- Make use of playful pyjamas to embrace the #PyjamaDressing and dayjama trends, adding various end uses for the items
- Offer socks value sets for the winter holiday gifting
- Drop in December

Proof points: Playful Simplicity

Percentage of consumers who are more likely to buy from brands that offer a sense of joy

WGSN.com

Our Future Consumer 2027 macro forecast emphasises that emotions significantly influence consumer desires and choices, **making joy an essential message for brands to convey**

Joyful motifs and #BoldMinimal patterns **bring a playful spirit to youthful sleepwear and loungewear ranges**, as highlighted in our Playful Simplicity forecast

Core prints show a steady increase on catwalks

A/W 25/26 vs A/W 24/25

▲ +2.8ppt
Florals

▲ +1.6ppt
Plaid/Checks

▲ +1.1ppt
Stripes

WGSN.com

Commercial core prints are gaining popularity and will offer **widespread commercial appeal to complement the playfulness**

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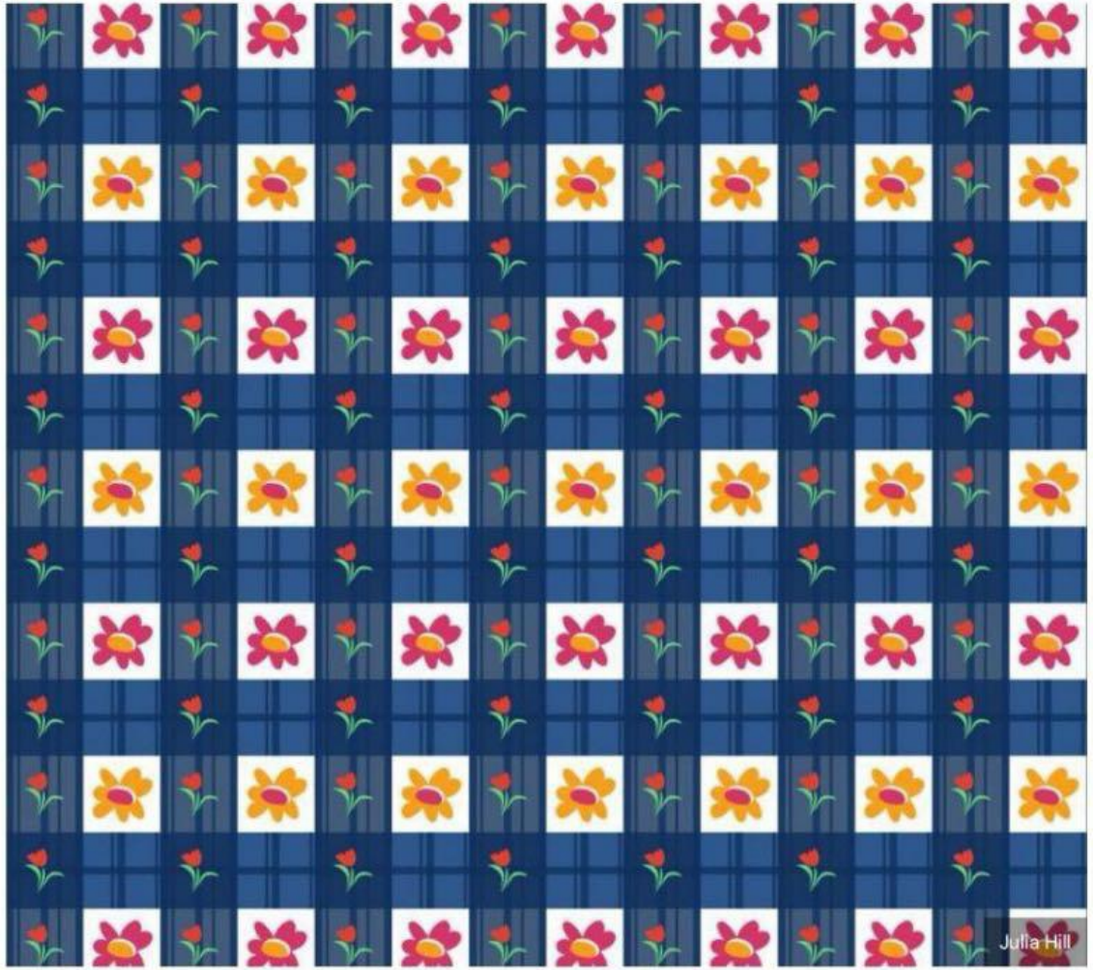


TIP: Protect

Crafted Story (Re)Telling

Take #NuHistorics and restorytelling narratives to present vintage aesthetics, celebrating crafts.

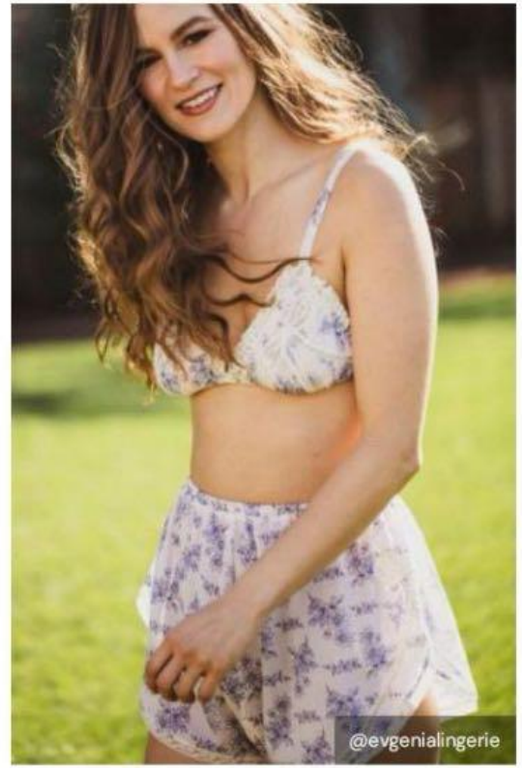
Design strategies

- Feature Toile de Jouy pattern with flora and fauna, incorporating #Birds and swans as key icons
- Use delicate #DitsyFlorals inspired by vintage china tableware to offer familiarity
- Apply to piped pyjamas for versatility, while romantic bramis and vintage-inspired bloomers provide a #PrettyFeminine look
- Source vintage or archived brocades, lace and embroideries to create unique day-to-night pieces that appeal to Gen Z
- Drop in November

Desmond & Dempsey

Benjamin Benmoyal

Ralph Lauren


@evgenialingerie

@gelatopique_official

Selkie

@fruitybooty

Proof points: Crafted Story (Re)Telling

#NuHistorics surge on WGSN's Fashion Feed

▲ 260%

2024 vs 2023

Brands are increasingly **honouring their histories by reintroducing archival silhouettes and patterns**, presented through a new lens

Brands will need to **embrace Gen Z's passion for archival fashion and by re-edition drops and Restorytelling narratives** as they celebrate individual expression with historical and rare pieces

Views for "vintage" uptrend globally

▲ 64%

YoY

To break free from monotony, **consumers are drawn to vintage aesthetics and unique items**, fueling the growth of the vintage resale market (TikTok worldwide, Feb-Apr 2025 vs Feb-Apr 2024)

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